

STREAMLINING IT PROCUREMENT: AUTOMATING STANDARD LAPTOP ORDERS WITH FLOW DESIGNER

Project Overview

The project “**Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer**” focuses on automating the process of requesting and managing standard laptop orders using the **ServiceNow Platform and Flow Designer**. The project is designed to reduce manual effort, improve task management, speed up the procurement process, and create a consistent workflow for standard laptop requests.

In a traditional IT procurement process, laptop requests may require repeated manual activities such as checking the request, obtaining approval, creating tasks, assigning work to the IT team, updating the request status, and informing the requester. These activities may result in delays, inconsistent request handling, and reduced process visibility.

The proposed solution uses **ServiceNow Flow Designer** to automate the request-to-fulfilment process. When a user submits a request for a standard laptop through the **Service Catalog**, the configured flow is triggered automatically. The flow evaluates the request, performs the required approval process, and continues with the appropriate fulfilment or notification actions. The project also includes a rejection path so that requests that are not approved can be handled appropriately.

The complete project is divided into the following eight phases:

1. Brainstorming and Ideation Phase
2. Requirement Analysis Phase
3. Project Design Phase
4. Project Planning Phase
5. Project Development Phase
6. Project Testing Phase
7. Project Documentation Phase
8. Project Demonstration Phase

PHASE 1: BRAINSTORMING AND IDEATION

1.1 Objective

The main objective of the Brainstorming and Ideation Phase is to identify a practical IT procurement problem and develop an automation-based solution using **ServiceNow Flow Designer**.

The project idea was developed around the manual process involved in requesting and procuring standard laptops for employees. The team examined how repetitive procurement activities could be transformed into an automated and structured workflow.

1.2 Problem Identification

The initial stage of the project focused on understanding the difficulties that may occur in a traditional manual laptop procurement process.

The identified problems included:

- Repeated manual activities during request processing.
- Delays in obtaining required approvals.
- Inconsistent handling of similar requests.
- Difficulty in maintaining process visibility.
- Manual creation and assignment of IT-related tasks.
- Increased possibility of errors during repetitive operations.

These issues created the need for a standard and automated process for frequently requested IT equipment.

1.3 Idea Generation

The team considered automation as a method of improving the standard laptop procurement process. The idea was to use **Flow Designer** to establish a structured workflow that could automatically process the request after submission.

The proposed concept was based on a simple principle:

A standard laptop request should automatically initiate the required workflow instead of requiring every activity to be performed manually.

1.4 Proposed Solution

The proposed system uses ServiceNow Flow Designer to connect different procurement activities into one workflow.

The initial concept follows this sequence:

Laptop Request Submission → Condition Check → Approval → Fulfilment/Notification → Completion

The flow can automatically determine whether the submitted request corresponds to a standard laptop order and then continue with the appropriate activities.

1.5 Expected Output

The expected output of this phase is the project concept and initial automation idea.

The produced concept is that when a standard laptop request is submitted, the system should initiate the necessary approval and fulfilment activities through an automated flow.

1.6 Phase Result

At the end of Phase 1, the project problem, automation concept, application area, and proposed solution were identified.